

THE BUZZ

DEFENCE STOCKS

ARMED FOR GROWTH

The defence sector is poised for a phenomenal rise, evident in the near 21% rise in the Nifty India Defence index since April 22, the day of the terror attack in Pahalgam

BY RAHUL OBEROI

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► **INDIA'S DEFENCE SECTOR** has been witnessing strong growth, largely fuelled by the government's sustained push for self-reliance in manufacturing, record-breaking order books, and strategic policy initiatives. Recent events, such as the Pahalgam terror attack on April 22, 2025, and the subsequent 'Opera-

tion Sindoor' by the Indian Armed Forces, showcased the power of Indigenous weapons—from drones to missiles and radars—to the world.

Market watchers believe that the country's defence sector is strategically positioned for long-term growth. Following the recent cross-border tensions, defence-related

stocks witnessed heavy buying in the domestic stock market. This is evident from the nearly 21% rise in the Nifty India Defence index since April 22, the day of the terror attack in Pahalgam. The market valuation of the Nifty India Defence index surged by ₹1.83 lakh crore to ₹11.06 lakh crore on May 19, 2025 from



ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA